

System level AI

Looking at 2026, smartphone evolution will be driven by how intelligently technology is applied, not just by hardware upgrades. AI will move deeper into the system level, shaping performance, imaging, and everyday usage in more contextual ways. At the same time, efficiency will matter as much as raw power. Users want flagship performance that is sustainable, consistent,



and reliable over long-term use. Another key factor will be deeper hardware and software co-optimisation between brands and platform partners. This time we started working together with Qualcomm around 24 months back, which is very different from the industry normal. This approach will allow smartphones to deliver more meaningful, personalised experiences.

—ROBIN LIU, CEO, ONEPLUS INDIA

Bringing cinema home

Now 100-inch TVs are a revolution. This trend started during COVID, people want to have a cinema experience at home. So that is where the shift of the screen size is happening. We are bringing technology like Mini LED because it gives you a real cinema experience. If you ask me for 2026 planning, offline is the most critical element. For a product like TV, demonstration plays a very crucial role. You have to really see the TV on shop floor. What the contrast looks like, how the brightness feels. We plan to display our products in most offline retail chains.

—PANKAJ RANA, CEO, HISENSE INDIA



Redefining smartphones

Devices will move beyond being smart tools to becoming intelligent companions that anticipate user needs. With AI-native platforms and on-device intelligence, smartphones will deliver smarter battery, and real-time creation experiences, while enabling agent-based AI that need minimal user input. As AI and imaging converge, cameras will evolve into creative partners, while local processing improves privacy. By 2026, consumers will value trust and dependability over raw specs, and successful brands will be making advanced technology that feels invisible, safe, and always available.

—GOLDEE PATNAIK, COMMUNICATIONS HEAD, OPPO INDIA



Future of home entertainment

When we started this whole project on projectors, the first people that came to mind to build something was MediaTek. They have supported our journey of building out a unique solution for the Indian market from the beginning, and that is just a starting point for us in this collaboration. Projectors today

are where smart TVs were back in 2018. We think that this can actually become almost 10X over the next four to five years. For 2026, we hope to become a leading light in the home entertainment space. Our philosophy is 'tech that sparks joy.' We want to build something that's different, that adds joy to a customer's life, so we look to do more in TVs, projectors, and other categories.

—KAILASH SANKARANARAYANAN, CO-FOUNDER, LUMIO HOME SERVICES

